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EDUCATION

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| Purdue University, Mitchell E. Daniels, Jr. School of Business | West Lafayette, IN |
| ◦ Ph.D. in Economics | 2020 - August 2026 (Expected) |
| Committee: Victoria Prowse (Chair), Kevin Mumford, Tim Bond, Ben Zou | |
| ◦ M.S. in Economics | 2022 |
| Purdue University, Mitchell E. Daniels, Jr. School of Business | West Lafayette, IN |
| ◦ B.S. in Economics | 2018-2020 |
| Minors in Mathematics and Statistics | |
| China Agricultural University | Beijing, China |
| ◦ B.A. in Economics | 2016 - 2020 |

RESEARCH INTERESTS

Public Economics, Labor Economics, Economics of Education, and Health Economics

PEER-REVIEWED PUBLICATIONS

- [1] The Impact of Minimum Wage on Intra-Household Decision-Making: Evidence from Japan. *Forthcoming, Social Indicators Research*

Abstract: This paper examines how increases in wives' market value, measured through wages, shape intra-household tradeoffs in Japan. Using a Difference-in-Differences strategy, I exploit minimum wage hikes to study their effects on wives' relative income and time allocation. Evidence from the Japanese Household Panel Survey shows that higher minimum wages reduce the gender wage gap by encouraging wives—particularly those with young children—to enter the labor force and extend their working hours. Wives without young children respond by increasing employment while reducing time devoted to home production, whereas those with young children primarily adjust by sacrificing leisure. By contrast, husbands exhibit limited responses to wage changes. These findings highlight that narrowing the gender wage gap, while promoting women's labor market participation, can also intensify their household burden. The results underscore the need for policies that address not only income disparities but also inequalities in unpaid work and time use within households.

WORKING PAPERS

- [1] **Labor Supply under Nonlinear Tax Programs: Evidence from the Interaction of EITC and Wage Shocks.** *Job Market Paper*

Abstract: This paper develops a framework for how nonlinear tax schedules—focusing on the Earned Income Tax Credit (EITC)—shape labor supply responses to wage shocks. We introduce a commuting-zone average treatment effect (CZATE), an equilibrium local-market estimand for how changes in EITC generosity affect commuting-zone employment, and an envelope semi-elasticity that maps generosity into the wage–employment relationship. The empirical estimates reproduce canonical individual-level employment responses to the EITC and are robust to contemporaneous welfare reform. Using local booms, China trade shocks, and minimum-wage hikes, we find that a \$100 increase in EITC generosity rotates the wage–employment slope by

about 0.05–0.2 percentage points per 1% wage change, with larger rotations in economic downturns. The results imply that the cyclical consequences of EITC expansions depend on where eligible workers lie on the schedule, making phase-in versus phase-out exposure central to in-work credit design.

- [2] When Income Support Hurts and Helps: Health Effects of Survivors Benefits (with Hao Li). *Reject and Resubmit, Journal of Health Economics*

Abstract: How does income support after widowhood affect health over the life cycle? To answer this question, we study Social Security Survivors Benefits, which become available to widowed individuals at age 60 in the United States. Using a fuzzy regression discontinuity design with Health and Retirement Study data, we find that eligibility reduces self-reported good health and increases diabetes diagnoses in the short run, with effects concentrated among financially dependent widows. These effects are not explained by changes in medical utilization but coincide with increased food expenditures, suggesting a consumption-based mechanism. To examine longer-run consequences, we exploit the 1965 reform that lowered the eligibility age from 65 to 60 and use cohort mortality data to compare cohorts with different exposure durations. We find that expanded eligibility improves survival to age 70. Descriptive cause-of-death patterns indicate larger mortality declines from cardiovascular disease, tuberculosis, and suicide in high-widow-prevalence states. Together, the results suggest that income support can generate short-run health risks while improving longer-run survival.

- [3] Import Competition and the Redistribution of Employment Across Skill Groups in U.S. Local Labor Markets (with Victoria Prowse).

Abstract: Over the past several decades, import competition has reshaped employment in advanced economies. Initial waves of manufacturing imports displaced large numbers of less-educated workers. More recently, the rise of high-skill-intensive imports has raised concerns about the vulnerability of educated labor. The labor market consequences of globalization thus depend not only on the overall scale of imports but also on the skill composition of traded goods and the ability of local labor markets to transmit and amplify these shocks. This paper revisits the “China shock” through a new lens by distinguishing between local exposure to low-skill-intensive and high-skill-intensive imports. Even when direct employment losses in manufacturing are comparable, broader adjustments diverge: some local economies absorb displaced workers into non-manufacturing industries, while others experience persistently weaker re-employment prospects. Patterns of adjustment also vary across demographic groups and skill levels, underscoring the role of both worker characteristics and local task requirements in shaping outcomes. By highlighting these composition effects within import shocks, the analysis reconciles mixed evidence on regional recovery and underscores the importance of sector-specific retraining and placement policies.

- [4] Friction, Sorting, and Stratification: Evidence from Common Application Adoption (with Kevin Mumford).

Abstract: This paper studies how reducing college application costs reshapes student sorting across the quality distribution. Exploiting staggered adoption of the Common Application across 2,000+ four-year institutions from 2002 to 2019, we show that friction reduction generates sharply heterogeneous effects by selectivity tier. Least-selective schools gain in entering-class quality immediately but see the spread widen at the three-year horizon as the lower tail retreats. Most-selective schools experience a large enrollment surge and an immediate parallel upward shift in both SAT percentiles, sustained at three years. Medium-selective schools exhibit immediate SAT compression that inverts by year three into a widening gap alongside sustained enrollment decline. A Bartik shift-share design using pre-determined state origin shares addresses endogenous adoption timing and confirms the enrollment effects. The results reveal a sorting cascade in which improved matching concentrates talent at elite schools, leaves medium-selective schools systematically more vulnerable, and contributes to the decade-long decline in the aggregate college-

going rate.

WORKING IN PROGRESS

[1] The Tiger Neighbor Effect (With Kevin Mumford and Ben Zou).

CONFERENCE TALKS

SEA 95th Annual Meeting, Tampa, FL	Fall 2025
118th Annual Conference on Taxation, Boston, MA	Fall 2025
International Conference on Empirical Economics, PSU-Altoona, PA	Summer 2025
SEA 93rd Annual Meeting, New Orleans, LA	Fall 2023
Chinese Economists Society Annual Conference, China	Summer 2023

HONORS AND AWARDS

National Tax Association Fiscal Sustainability Travel Fellowship	Fall 2025
Krannert Doctoral Student Research Fund	Fall 2024
Krannert Certificate for Distinguished Teaching	Summer 2023
Frederick N. Andrews Fellowship	2020-2025
Jinlongyu College Scholar (Top 1%)	2017

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

Instructor

- Principles of Economics ECON210 (undergraduate) Summer 2025
class size: 36; teaching evaluation: 4.16/5
- Microeconomics ECON251 (undergraduate) Summer 2023
class size: 74; teaching evaluation: 4.51/5

Review Session Instructor

- Labor Economics (undergraduate) Spring 2024

PROFESSIONAL SERVICE

Referee for <i>Journal of Economic Behavior and Organization</i>	
Panelist on Job Market Mock Interviews	Fall 2024
Labor Lunch Organizer for Department	Fall & Spring 2022
Business Doctoral Student Association Treasurer	Fall & Spring 2022

SKILLS

Programming: Stata, Python, R, Matlab, Mathematica, $\text{\LaTeX}$

REFERENCES

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Purdue University
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